Week 2 | Friday checks

2026-10-23 | Three brief items per check. Record accuracy and support separately.

Spelling

Use three words explicitly taught from each learner's current HMH sound-spelling pattern. Say the word, use it in a sentence, repeat it. Record encoding separately from supported pattern recognition. Words: _____ _____ _____.

Grade 3 reading | Big Pumpkin

Use the actual book, with the planned access supports.

1. What is this book teaching us about?

Teacher key: Pumpkins and their growth, supported by the selected pages.

2. Show a fact about how pumpkins grow.

Teacher key: A growth fact actually shown on the selected page.

3. How does this fact help explain the book's main idea?

Teacher key: Connects the selected fact to the central idea with planned access.

Grade 4 reading | Big Pumpkin

Use the actual book, with the planned access supports.

1. What problem is shown in this scene?

Teacher key: The witch loses belongings; animals help retrieve them and join her. The animals later help save her from the dragon.

2. What does a character do about it?

Teacher key: An action actually shown in the bookmarked scene.

3. How does that action affect the result? Show where the book tells you.

Teacher key: A supported connection between the action and outcome; accept planned response mode.

Math | Week 2

Grade 3

3.4H | 3.4J

1. Share 8 counters between 2 plates.

2. Make groups of 3 from 9 counters.

3. Build a model of 6 divided by 2.

Teacher key

4 on each; 3 groups; 2 groups of 3 or 3 groups of 2 with matching interpretation

Grade 4

4.5A

1. Build 2 bags with 3 pencils each, then give away 1. Show both steps.

2. Draw a strip diagram and write (2 x 3) - 1 = n for the pencils left.

3. Solve n and explain how the model shows the result.

Teacher key

6 then 5; diagram represents 6 with 1 removed and 5 remaining, equation uses n; n = 5 with both operations represented.

Science | Week 2

Experiment replaces the separate science quiz

Pumpkin push investigation: use a lightweight pumpkin model on a tray. Grade 3 predicts and compares a push and pull (3.7B). Grade 4 rolls a toy car into the stationary model and observes energy transfer (4.8A). Repeat three trials with the same surface. Save one prediction, observation and explanation per learner.

Grade 3

3.7A | 3.7B

1. Show a push that starts a car moving.
2. Show a pull that changes a car position.
3. Predict what changes when a moving car hits a stationary car.

Teacher key

Push demonstration; pull demonstration; stationary car can move or position changes

Grade 4

4.8A

1. Predict what happens when a moving car reaches a stationary pumpkin model.
2. Run a fresh trial and show what moves.
3. Identify evidence that energy transferred.

Teacher key

Reasonable prediction; identifies observed movement; second object changes motion after contact. Score the observation against the actual trial.

Additional product: Social studies

Writing: one clear idea, relevant detail/reason and understandable communication. Social studies: a correct person/event or community claim, relevant source evidence and supported connection. Score each criterion 0/1 with prompts noted; apply school grading rules.